

have money to pay for private college. And with \$400,000 or \$500,000 on your Parent's Confidential Statement, Johnny will have a tough time getting financial aid.

But two-thirds of four-year-college students attend public institutions. Some of those institutions are among the finest in the country. Both Stanford and the University of California at Berkeley, for example, rank among the top ten universities in the country. Their San Francisco Bay Area campuses are about fifty miles apart, date from about the same era, and are about the same size. Both schools have excellent libraries, medical schools, historians, and football teams. A degree from either Stanford or Berkeley opens doors from New Mexico to New Guinea. The schools seem similar in every way except one. Stanford is private and costs up to \$20,000 a year. U.C. Berkeley is financed by the state of California. According to the College Board, a commuting student there paid less than \$1,500 in academic 1986-87. That amounts to only \$5,880 over four years, about average for public four-year colleges.

The Association of Research Libraries ranks universities based on their research potential. Listed according to the quantity of books, tapes, microfiche, and other material, the top ten are:

Harvard	Private
Yale	Private
U. of Illinois	Public
U. of California (Berkeley)	Public
U. of Michigan	Public
Columbia	Private
U. of Texas	Public
Stanford	Private
U. of California (Los Angeles)	Public
U. of Chicago	Private

Of the top thirty research institutions in the country, the association found that seventeen are public and thirteen private.